Heroes in a Half Shell

by T. J. Kenda



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SCENE ONE

(*The television turns on with a news report in progress.*)

APRIL. …much more than just a series of small, isolated incidents. It's apparent an organized criminal element is at work. Citizens of New York are waiting for someone to save them. This has been April O'Neil reporting for Channel Three Eyewitness News.

(*Television turns off.*)

LEONARDO. Master Splinter, we've been ignoring these attacks long enough. The time has surely come for us to go to the surface and fight.

SPLINTER. Fifteen years ago I was a pet of my master Yoshi. I was mimicking his movements from my cage and learning the secret art of ninja. When we were forced to come to New York, I found myself wandering the sewers. That's when I came upon a shattered glass jar and four baby turtles.

MIKEY. That was, like, totally us. Cowabunga!

RAPHAEL. Shut up, Mikey.

SPLINTER. The little ones were crawling in a strange, glowing ooze.

DONATELLO. Actually, it was molecular irradiated mutonium.

RAPHAEL. Shut up, Donatello.

SPLINTER. Then, one of them spoke.

BABY. Pizza! Pizza!

SPLINTER. Soon, I began their training and teaching them all that I had learned from my master. I gave them all names.

LEONARDO. (*brandishes his swords*) Leonardo!

MIKEY. (*brandishes his nunchucks*) Cowabunga!

LEONARDO. Michelangelo!

MIKEY. Right!

DONATELLO. (*brandishes his bow*) I'm Donatello!

RAPHAEL. (*brandishes his tsai*) Shut up!

SPLINTER. And you became the Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles, heroes in a half shell.

LEONARDO. Ok, but seriously, Splinter, can we get the shell out of the sewers yet?

SCENE TWO

SPLINTER. My dear sons, the time is not yet right to surface.

LEONARDO. Don't you think we're ready?

SPLINTER. No, my sons. Your ninja skills have not yet reached their peak. Just as I did, fifteen years ago, living in Japan as a pet to my master Yoshi. I was mimicking his movements

from my cage and learning…(*walks away still telling the story*)

LEONARDO. Master? Why does he always do that?

DONATELLO. I guess he's meditating.

MIKEY. I say we, like, go up and, like, surf this crime wave.

RAPHAEL. Shut up.

DONATELLO. Raphael is right. We can't do that.

LEONARDO. Yes, we can.

DONATELLO. No, we can't.

MIKEY. Okay, while you two, like, argue, I'm going to do some meditating of my own.

SCENE THREE

(*The television turns on with a news report in progress.*)

APRIL. …mysterious gang of ninjas known as The Foot. I know, it sounds like a funky club for podiatrists. But our recent crime wave is reminiscent of a secret band of ninja thieves who once operated in Japan. If only we knew who their leader was. This is April O'Neil reporting for Channel Three Eyewitness News.

(*The television turns off.*)

NINJA. Master Shredder? What should we do about the lady reporter? She must not reveal our existence to the world. Surely the Foot must stop her. Or *stomp* her.

SHREDDER. Indeed. Find her. Silence her.

NINJA. Yes, master. (*draws sword and disappears*)

SCENE FOUR

APRIL. (*enters*, *humming to herself*) Hmm, hmm, hmm.

NINJA. We've been waiting for you.

APRIL. For me? April O'Neil, Channel Three Eyewitness News?

NINJA. I deliver a message.

APRIL. (*opens a fortune cookie and reads the fortune*) Your mouth may yet bring you much trouble, Miss O'Neil. Your lucky numbers are 5, 4, 3, 2…

NINJA. 1! Attack! (*NINJA draws his sword to attack. The turtles intervene.*)

LEONARDO. Not so fast, Foot.

DONATELLO. Are you all right, Miss O'Neil?

APRIL. I think so. Who are you?

DONATELLO. I am (*hesitates*) a shadow! Ninja vanish. (*The smoke bomb goes off but DONATELLO doesn't disappear.*)

APRIL. Was that supposed to make you disappear?
MIKEY. Whoa.
APRIL. It's kind of hard to disappear as a six foot turtle in a trench coat.
RAPHAEL. Shut up. (*RAPHAEL knocks her out.*) Ninja vanish.

SCENE FIVE
SHREDDER. Is O'Neil dead?
NINJA. Master, we failed. There were creatures. They were mutant teenagers.
SHREDDER. Aren't they all?
NINJA. No, they were ninjas.
SHREDDER. So are you.
NINJA. They were turtles!
SHREDDER. Heroes in a half shell?
NINJA. Yes. We were defeated. We were (*beat*) de-footed.
SHREDDER. Hmm, so there is a new enemy: freaks of nature who interfere with our business. Find out more. You are my eyes and ears…
NINJA. …and Foot.
SHREDDER Find them. Together, we will punish these creatures! These...turtles!

SCENE SIX
LEONARDO. Master!
SPLINTER. Many years ago, when I lived in Japan, I was a pet of my master Yoshi. I was mimicking his movements from my cage...
LEONARDO. Sensei, there is no time. We just met ninjas of the Foot.
SPLINTER. The Foot?
DONATELLO. Yes, master.
SPLINTER. I heard of the Foot fifteen years ago when I lived in Japan, I was a pet of my master Yoshi…(*trails off*)
MIKEY. Like, what do we do?
LEONARDO. Let us meditate.
RAPHAEL. Shut up.
DONATELLO. That's the plan from our great leader?
LEONARDO. I never said I was a great leader.
RAPHAEL. Shut up.
LEONARDO. That attitude of yours isn't helping anything, Raph.
RAPHAEL. Maybe I'll just take my attitude and leave! (*shoves his head down into his shell*)
LEONARDO. Oh, very mature, Raph. (*knocks on the shell*) Raph? Raph. Forget it.

(*The television turns on.*)

APRIL. This just in: I've been kidnapped by the Foot clan. April O'Neil, Channel Three Eyewitness News.
MIKEY. Like, didn't we just save her?
DONATELLO. They must have come back after we left her unconscious in the street.
LEONARDO. Criminal mastermind fiends! Master, how much longer must we wait?
SPLINTER. (*looks at watch*) The time has come. Let's go.

SCENE SEVEN

(*A huge fight scene commences with random exclamations from the turtles.*)

APRIL. Yo, turtle, would you mind saving April O'Neil, Channel Three Eyewitness News?
RAPHAEL. Shut up!
LEONARDO. Man, this was easy.
DONATELLO. (*thinks about it*) Yeah…*too* easy.
SHREDDER. (*enters*) You fight well in the old style, but you've caused me enough trouble. Now you face The Shredder. (*SHREDDER takes a piece of paper and shreds it.*)
MIKEY. Does anybody, like, have any idea about who or what this is?
APRIL. I don't know, but I'll bet it never has to look for a can opener. April O'Neil reporting for Channel Three Eyewitness News.
DONATELLO. Raph, get him.
RAPHAEL. (*RAPHAEL gets beaten up.)* Shut up.
MIKEY. Hey Leo, why don't you go next?

(*The turtles fight and get beaten.*)

APRIL. It seems we'll be eating turtle soup tonight. April O'Neil, Channel Three Eyewitness News.
RAPHAEL. Shut up!
SPLINTER. It is ok, my sons. I got him. I know you well, Shredder.
SHREDDER. As I know you, Splinter. I will finish what I started fifteen years ago when you lived in Japan as a pet of your master Yoshi.
MIKEY. What is it with these guys and that story?
SPLINTER. Death comes for us all, Shredder, but something much worse comes for you. For when you die, it will be without honor.
LEONARDO. Ooooh, snap!

(*SPLINTER and SHREDDER fight. SPLINTER wins*.)

LEONARDO. Master Splinter, are you ok?
SPLINTER. Better than I have been in fifteen years, when I lived in Japan as a pet of my master Yoshi.
LEONARDO. Miss O'Neil, you are safe now.
APRIL. Thank you. How can I ever repay you?
RAPHAEL. Shut up. (*knocks her out*)
SPLINTER. Ninja vanish.

SCENE EIGHT
(*The television turns on to a news broadcast that is already in progress*.)

NEWS. Amazing! Then what happened, Ms. O'Neil?
APRIL. Then guys in the black pajamas jumped me.
NEWS. Miss O'Neil, you still haven't told us how you got away from your attackers.
APRIL. Some citizens of New York actually came to my rescue. Who says everyone in the Big Apple looks the other way? This is April O'Neil reporting for Channel Three Eyewitness News.
NEWS. Um, this is my interview.

(*The television turns off*.)

LEONARDO. Listen, Raph, about what I said before, about not needing you and all…
RAPHAEL. Shut up.
SPLINTER. I am proud of you, my sons. Tonight you have learned the final and greatest truth of the ninja: that ultimate mastery comes not of the body but of the mind.
DONATELLO. …and of the Foot.
MIKEY. Let's celebrate! Pizza?